

—BOB INGRAM—

Center begins to look like caging arena



Templeton

A LOOK AT the inside of the U.T. El Paso Special Events Center, the future playhouse of Miner basketball teams.

The sloping concrete rows of seats made it look stark and barren. It was like a giant sitting around without any clothes on.

It's not a round house like some basketball arenas. It's more rectangular than round. "It's sort of a cross between the Utah University basketball arena and Marriott Center at Brigham Young in design," said Scott Binning, U.T. El Paso sports information director. Only it's smaller.

A bulldozer was sitting on the floor where teams will play in the future. Boxes were piled high. Tools were scattered around. It was like children leaving their toys lying around the driveway and yard.

Those boxes contained the chairs that will be placed in the concrete rows. Each chair is colored a bright orange. No reds, white, blues, etc. They'll make the place sparkle. I noticed they came from a firm in Michigan. That company will get a pretty good-sized check if it already hasn't gotten one. Maybe one of \$200,000 or more.

Moving headaches due

THERE ARE a lot of things to be done yet. A floor has to be laid. The scoreboard and its lights has to be raised over the center. The chairs have to be put in.

It's going to be a race to see if the Miners can open their Western Athletic Conference in the new arena in January.

The Sun Carnival Assn., rather than gamble on the Center being finished for its Sun Bowl Tournament has announced it will hold its next tournament at the old place, Memorial Gym.

There'll be a mad rush at moving time. It would have been much better had the Center been finished in the off-season so that there would be no overnight scurrying around.

There'll be a magic transformation in time. The debris will be cleaned up. The place will be shiny and immaculate. The landscaping will add to a beautification program.

It'll be the Miners' playground in basketball for many years. Around the turn of the century, maybe a larger one will be constructed. In the WAC, it's going to be bigger than the gyms at Wyoming and Colorado State but smaller than those of BYU, Utah, New Mexico, Arizona and Arizona State.

Adequate facilities

WITH THE COMPLETION of the Center, UTEP's athletic facilities will reach first class level.

Football in the Sun Bowl and track at Kidd Field are well cared for.

The AstroTurf and the new lights have put the Sun Bowl in the pent house area.

Andy Cohen is getting an on-the-campus baseball field. It will be better than going to Dudley Field and the Ysleta Cutoff for games. There's some doubt however about the outfield fences being far enough away from home plate.

The training center where athletes go for whirlpool baths and other treatment is the equal of those of other schools.

Tennis and gymnastic facilities could be improved.

Overall, though the UTEP athletic complex is just what the doctor (President Arleigh Templeton) ordered.